

TEMPORARY WORK PLATFORMS

Load capacity, full decking, safe access and fall protection.

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Temporary work platforms must be used only for their designed purpose, on a sound foundation and under competent-person control. Verify capacity, decking, guardrails, access, ties and the area below before work starts. Boxes, drums, pallets and improvised devices must never be used as work platforms.

KEY HAZARDS

 EDGE FALL	 DECK GAP	 UNSAFE ACCESS	 FALLING OBJECT
 OVERLOAD	 SLIPPERY SURFACE	 INADEQUATE TIE	 COLLAPSE / TIP

CRITICAL VALUES TO VERIFY IN THE FIELD

4 x Capacity against maximum intended load	46 cm General minimum platform width	1,8 m Construction fall-protection trigger
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REMEMBER - SERNEM

- | | | |
|-------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------------|
| S Stop and think | E Evaluate the risk | R Remove or reduce |
| N Never assume | E Ensure protection | M Monitor and communicate |

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STANDARDS AND FIELD REQUIREMENTS

OSHA Subparts L and M address platform design, access and fall protection together. Apply the stricter requirement where manufacturer instructions or local law set a higher standard.

OSHA 1926.451(a) CAPACITY AND DESIGN

Components must support their own weight and at least four times the maximum intended load; erection must follow the design.

OSHA 1926.451(b) FULL DECKING

Working levels must be fully decked as far as practicable; general platforms and walkways must be at least 46 cm wide.

OSHA 1926.451(e) SAFE ACCESS

Provide a suitable ladder, stair tower, ramp or equivalent access; never climb cross-braces.

OSHA 1926.501 / .502 FALL PROTECTION

Control open-edge and lower-level fall exposure with guardrails, safety nets or a personal fall-arrest system.

MINIMUM EVIDENCE BEFORE START

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Platform design and load class | ☐ Shift inspection and tag |
| ☐ Foundation and tie verification | ☐ Access and guardrail check |
| ☐ Area-below control plan | ☐ Competent-person record |

SUPERVISOR DISCUSSION POINTS

- Where do we verify this platform's load class?
- Who may remove or modify a component?
- What is the first action if foundation settlement is seen?

TEMPORARY PLATFORM PRE-START CHECK



Sound base - Full deck - Safe access - Guardrails - Tag - Barricade

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CRITICAL CONTROL MEASURES (HIERARCHY OF CONTROLS)

1. WORK AT GROUND LEVEL

Prepare components at ground level and use remote-access tools where practicable.

2. USE AN ENGINEERED PLATFORM

Provide a sound base, full decking, correct ties, guardrails and toe boards.

3. CONTROL ACCESS AND LOAD

Use approved access, display the load class and distribute materials evenly.

4. INSPECT AND TAG

A competent person must inspect before each shift and after changes; close any defective platform.

CRITICAL WARNING



Do not use a platform with missing guardrails, loose decking, settled foundations, improvised elevation or an invalid tag. Close the area and report it for authorized correction.

SITE CHECKLIST (BEFORE STARTING WORK)

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Competent-person inspection and tag valid | ☐ Foundation and supports sound |
| ☐ Platform fully decked and secured | ☐ Guardrails and toe boards complete |
| ☐ Approved access route clear | ☐ Load class known and not exceeded |
| ☐ Ties and braces complete | ☐ Area below barricaded |
| ☐ Weather and surface conditions suitable | |



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ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

Project / Site: _____ Date: _____

Presented by: _____ Work area: _____

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
3			
4			
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